

Product Feature Brief

Familiar Guest for the Mexico market — built for US & Canadian homeowners

Familiar Guest lets US and Canadian homeowners who own rental property in Mexico take bookings directly from their own repeat and trusted guests — keeping the guest relationship and the revenue that Airbnb's ~15.5% fee takes away. This brief defines the full feature set for launch and a recommended pricing plan.

Positioning: owner-first, repeat-guest-focused, invisible infrastructure (the booking page carries the owner's property name), simple to start, and trust built in by default. For this market the edge is **cross-border**: clean money movement, two languages, and trust strong enough to book a home in another country.

Who It's For

- **Owners:** US and Canadian individuals who own one or a few homes in Mexico (initial beachhead: the Todos Santos · Los Cabos · La Paz corridor in Baja California Sur). They already rent on Airbnb and have a base of return guests.
- **Guests:** travelers from the US, Canada, and Mexico — including snowbirds on long winter stays and Spanish-first Mexican nationals.

Feature Set

Features are grouped by function. Each is marked **CORE** (original product) or **CROSS-BORDER** (the six Mexico-market additions).

A. Effortless Onboarding

- **CORE** **Photo upload** — phone (QR/text-a-link), cloud storage (Google Photos, iCloud, Drive, Dropbox OAuth), and drag-and-drop. *No Airbnb scraping; owner-provided content only.*
- **CORE** **AI-written listing** — owner pastes their own text or answers a few prompts; AI produces a polished title, description, and amenity list to edit.
- **CORE** **Owner identity verification (Gate 1)** — Stripe-powered KYC; required before listing or collecting payment.
- **CORE** **Property ownership verification (Gate 2)** — for public listings; accepts Mexico-appropriate proof including **fideicomiso (bank trust)** and Mexican-corporation documents. Unlocks the Verified Owner badge

and public mode.

- **CROSS-BORDER** **Bilingual setup (EN/ES)** — the owner works in English; the listing publishes in both English and Spanish.

B. Calendar & Availability

- **CORE** **Inbound iCal sync** — paste export URLs from Airbnb, VRBO, Booking.com, Google/Apple Calendar, and PMS tools; refreshed every 15–30 min.
- **CORE** **Outbound .ics feed** — a unique export URL per listing for other platforms to read.
- **CORE** **"Last synced" timestamp** — sets clear expectations (iCal is near-real-time, not instant).

C. Booking Experience (Guest-Facing)

- **CORE** **Private branded booking link** — carries the property's name, not ours; works on mobile; no guest account required.
- **CROSS-BORDER** **Bilingual booking page + AI-translated messaging** — guest and owner each communicate in their own language; AI translates both ways in real time.
- **CROSS-BORDER** **Multi-currency display** — prices shown in the guest's currency (USD / CAD / MXN), all-in and transparent.
- **CROSS-BORDER** **Long-stay support** — weekly and monthly rates for snowbird stays.
- **CROSS-BORDER** **Split payments / installments** — collect a booking in two parts (an initial deposit now, balance before arrival), reducing friction on large bookings.
- **CORE** **Rental agreement** — auto-generated per booking (DocuSeal), signed digitally before payment clears; stored permanently.

D. Payments, Escrow & Cross-Border Money

- **CORE** **Stripe Connect (Custom)** — owners are paid "by Familiar Guest"; Stripe stays invisible and handles KYC and payee compliance.
- **CORE** **Escrow** — guest funds held until check-in via delayed payout. The cornerstone trust feature.
- **CORE** **Damage deposit** — held separately, released automatically after the inspection window.
- **CROSS-BORDER** **Cross-border payouts** — owner chooses payout currency and destination bank (US, Canada, or Mexico).
- **CORE** **Fees at cost** — card processing **and** currency conversion passed through to the owner at cost; net-zero to us.
- **CORE** **Free bookings** — owner marks a booking free (friends/family); charged \$5 from card on file. Card on file only required if this is enabled.

E. Trust & Safety

- **CORE** **Verified Owner badge** — every owner identity-verified via Stripe as a condition of payout.
- **CROSS-BORDER** **Cross-border trust framing** — escrow + verification + coverage packaged and messaged as *"safe to book a home in Mexico."*
- **CORE** **Guest screening (add-on)** — ID + fraud check via Truvi (supports Mexico).
- **CORE** **Protected booking (add-on)** — screening plus up to \$1M damage protection via Truvi.

F. Owner Operations (Remote / Absentee)

- **CROSS-BORDER** **Caretaker role** — a scoped, limited-access login for the local cleaner/caretaker (sees bookings, dates, prep tasks; never payments or the full guest list).
- **CROSS-BORDER** **Digital check-in** — automated check-in instructions and lockbox/smart-code support for self-arrival.
- **CORE** **Two booking modes** — trusted-guest mode (after Gate 1) and public mode (after Gate 2).

G. Guest Relationship & Retention

- **CORE** **Private Guest CRM** — directory with contact, stay history, notes, preferences, and trust tiers (vetted / returning / referral). Owned by the owner, never shared.
- **CROSS-BORDER** **Guest import + season-timed re-invite** — import past guests (contacts/spreadsheet) and auto-send "book again" invites timed to the Nov-Apr high season.
- **CORE** **One-click rebook** — post-checkout "same dates next year?" with details pre-filled.
- **CORE** **Referral system** — a trusted guest shares a link; the new guest is pre-vetted by association.
- **CORE** **Automated messaging (bilingual)** — confirmation, pre-arrival, check-in, mid-stay, checkout, deposit-release, via Resend.

H. Digital House Manual

- **CORE** **Private link** — accessible without an app; updated once, delivered forever.
- **CROSS-BORDER** **Baja-specific templates** — water/cistern, drinking water, power/blackouts, 4x4 roads, nearest services, emergency contacts, and useful Spanish phrases.

I. Owner Insights

- **CORE** **Income summary** — total income, nights booked, occupancy, top guests; export-ready.
- **CORE** **Consolidated multi-property view** — across all of an owner's listings (Pro plan).

J. Rental Income & Tax Payment Accounting **CORE DIFFERENTIATOR**

The hardest part of cross-border renting, made automatic — and something no competitor offers.

- **CROSS-BORDER** **Rental-income tracking** — every booking's income recorded and consolidated across all of an owner's units.
- **CROSS-BORDER** **Automatic lodging-tax handling** — calculate, collect, and (where FG is the platform-of-record) remit Mexican IVA/ISH and US occupancy/TOT per booking.
- **CROSS-BORDER** **Mexican host-tax withholding** — withhold and remit ISR/IVA to SAT on the owner's behalf where required of a digital platform.
- **CROSS-BORDER** **Documents for tax reporting** — per-booking tax breakdown, year-end income & tax statements, and clean exports for the owner's accountant (US Schedule E, Mexican filings).

Boundary & phasing: Tax Payments & Accounting is tax **handling and reporting, not tax advice** — owners use their own cross-border tax professional. It is built in phases (tax line items + Mexico withholding + exports first; fuller multi-jurisdiction accounting next) and is gated on legal/tax counsel — see the Compliance & Tax Addendum.

Recommended Pricing Plan

Plans are priced in **USD** (owners are US/Canadian and think in dollars). Card processing and currency conversion are always passed through at cost on every plan.

	Pay-as-you-go	Starter	Host	Pro
Price	5% per booking	\$15 / mo	\$29 / mo	\$49 / mo
Best for	Seasonal / testing	Single-home owners	Active owners, up to 5 homes	Owners with 6–10 homes
Properties	Pay per booking	1	Up to 5	6–10
Commission	5% per booking	None	None	None
Free bookings	\$5 each	Included	Included	Included
Multi-currency + cross-border payouts	✓	✓	✓	✓
Bilingual booking + AI translation	✓	✓	✓	✓
Escrow + Verified Owner	✓	✓	✓	✓
Rental agreement (e-sign)	✓	✓	✓	✓
Calendar sync (iCal)	✓	✓	✓	✓
Long-stay rates + installments	✓	✓	✓	✓
Guest CRM + season re-invite	✓	✓	✓	✓
Automated bilingual messaging	✓	✓	✓	✓
Digital house manual (Baja templates)	✓	✓	✓	✓
Consolidated multi-property reports	—	—	—	✓
Priority support	—	—	—	✓

All plans are subject to **payment processing fees** (card + currency conversion), passed through to the owner at cost.

Add-ons (any plan)

Add-on	Price	What the guest gets
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Guest Screening	\$5 per booking	ID verification + fraud check (Truvi)
Protected Booking	\$19.99 per booking	Screening + up to \$1M damage protection (Truvi)

Pricing logic

- **Every core and cross-border feature is available on every plan.** Trust and money-movement are the product — paywalling them would undercut the value proposition. Plans differ on **commission vs. flat fee, property count, and reporting/support**. (All plans include 5 caretaker seats — a baseline feature, not a marketed differentiator.)
- **Property cap is 10 for now** — we are focused on individual renters, not portfolio managers, so no tiers above 10 properties.
- **The crossover:** an owner booking more than ~\$3,600/year through Familiar Guest should move from Pay-as-you-go (5%) to **Starter** (\$180/yr), then to **Host** when they add a second property. Given Los Cabos/Baja nightly rates, most active owners cross the first threshold quickly — steering the base toward predictable subscription revenue.
- **Annual option:** offer ~2 months free on annual billing (Starter \$150/yr, Host \$290/yr, Pro \$490/yr) to improve retention and cash flow.
- **Launch offer:** first month free on any monthly plan for testing. Add-ons (screening, damage protection) and payment processing fees still apply during the free month.
- **Payment fees:** every plan is subject to payment processing fees (card + FX), passed through with no markup — preserving the trust positioning. *(A modest FX spread is a possible future revenue line, but not at launch.)*

Why this works for the Mexico market: the owner keeps essentially all of their nightly rate (vs. losing ~15.5% to Airbnb), pays only a small flat fee or commission, and gets cross-border payments, bilingual booking, and a built-in trust layer that a DIY site or a Venmo request can never match.

Launch Scope Summary

Included at launch	Deferred (post-launch)
All core features + the cross-border features above	Fuller multi-jurisdiction tax accounting (phase 2 of Rental Income & Tax Payment Accounting)
Rental Income & Tax Payment Accounting — phase 1 (income tracking, tax line items, Mexico withholding, reporting documents)	Platform-backed booking guarantee (needs funded reserve)
Trusted-guest + public modes; Truvi screening & damage (add-ons)	Guest "trust passport" / portable reputation
Three-tier pricing + two add-ons	Double-booking radar, owner-owned reviews (next iteration)

Note: tax payments/accounting roll-out is gated on counsel and the Mexico platform-withholding determination (Compliance & Tax Addendum).